> Glad is the Bairām-moon for him who sees both the face of the Moon and the Moon-face of his friend;
>
> Sad is the Bairām-moon for me, far away from thy face and from thee.
>
> O Bābur! dream of your luck when your Feast is the meeting, your New-year the face;
>
> For better than that could not be with a hundred New-years and Bairāms.

After crossing the Gūmāl torrent, Babur and his men took the route along the skirt of the hills, while they faced south. After having ridden for a couple of miles, Babur found some bloodthirsty Afghāns on the lower edge of the hill slope. Babur along with a few of his men went after them. Most of them fled, but some began to make silly gestures on the rocky piles of the foothills. One of them took post on a single rock, seeming to have a cliff on the further side of it —he had no way to escape.

Sulṭān Qulī Chūnāq came forward and slashed his head with ease. Having seen it happen in front of his eyes, Babur showered Sulṭān Qulī with favours and promotions. At another pile of rock, Qūtlūq-qadam exchanged blows with an Afghān and chopped off his head.

Kūpūk Beg got hand-on-collar with an Afghān at another hill. They both rolled to the bottom of the hill while fighting. Finally, the Afghān was arrested and presented to Babur. He took quite a few prisoners. However, they were freed instead of being beheaded.

They had begun to march further south through the plain, closely skirting Mehtar Sulaimān. They reached a small township called Bīlah after three nights. It lay on the banks of river Sindh and depended on Multān. Babur saw that some villagers crossed the river on boats, others got into the water to cross it, and some stood on an island in front of Bīlah. Most of Babur’s men, and horses in the mail, leapt in the river and crossed to the island. Some, unfortunately, drowned, including a thin slave, Qul-i-arūk, the head tent-pitcher, one Jahāngīr Mīrzā’s servant and Qāītmās Turkmān.

Meanwhile, the villagers had already crossed the river and looking at the fiery Sindh water, some of them began to wave swords, trying to scare away Babur’s men. Soon, Qul-i-bāyazīd, one of Babur’s men had crossed to the island. With intent to dive into the river, he stripped himself and his horse right in front of them. Soon he dived into the river. The water on the other side of the island was perhaps thrice as wide compared to what it was at Babur’s end. Qul-i-bāyazīd made his horse swim towards them till they reached a shallow patch where his weight would be up-borne, with the water being as high as the saddle flap. He couldn’t stay there for long. No one could come to support him . . . rather there was no chance that anyone could support him. They shot a few